FairChild Institute

UI/UX Design Institute

12-Month Practical UX & UI Design Mentorship Programme

FairChild Institute

Month 1

Digital, Design & Computing Foundations

Duration 4 weeks

Month Journey

Week	Theme	Core Topics	Guided Practical	Required Evidence
1	Digital products and design roles	UX vs UI vs product design; designer, product manager and developer responsibilities; user and business goals	Compare two familiar apps and identify their users, goals and friction	Comparison notes and problem statements
2	Human-centred design and discovery	Discover–define–ideate cycle; assumptions vs evidence; research questions; user needs	Prepare an interview guide and conduct a small practice interview	Research questions and observation notes
3	Figma foundations	Files, pages, frames, layers, shapes, text, images, components, sharing and version history	Recreate a simple screen and organise its layers	Organised Figma starter file
4	Product teardown and critique	Task analysis, friction points, design rationale and evidence-based recommendations	Review a banking, transport, education or commerce product and present findings	Product teardown presentation

FairChild Institute

Month 2

Information Architecture & User Flows

Duration 4 weeks

Month Journey

Week	Theme	Core Topics	Guided Practical	Required Evidence
1	Content and navigation	Information architecture, categories, labels, taxonomy and hierarchy	Inventory content and group it into meaningful sections	Content inventory and IA outline
2	Sitemaps and card sorting	Open/closed card sorting; interpreting patterns; sitemap conventions	Run a small card-sort exercise and draft a sitemap	Card-sort findings and sitemap
3	User and task flows	Entry points, goals, actions, decisions, system responses and completion states	Map one primary task from start to completion	Primary user flow diagram
4	Alternative paths and review	Happy paths, errors, edge cases and secondary tasks; navigation critique	Add alternative and failure paths; peer-review clarity	Revised flows and UX blueprint

FairChild Institute

Month 3

Wireframing & UX Problem Solving

Duration 4 weeks

Month Journey

Week	Theme	Core Topics	Guided Practical	Required Evidence
1	Sketching and prioritisation	Paper sketches, content hierarchy, affordance, feedback and progressive disclosure	Sketch three approaches to one key screen	Annotated paper sketches
2	Digital low-fidelity wireframes	Wireframe fidelity, layout hierarchy, consistency and content prioritisation	Create a connected set of core screens in Figma	Low-fidelity screen set
3	States and responsive thinking	Empty, loading, error, success and disabled states; mobile/tablet/ desktop considerations	Design core states and adapt one screen to another viewport	State inventory and responsive wireframe
4	Wireframe prototype and critique	Clickable low-fidelity flows; structured critique; prioritising feedback	Connect screens into a testable prototype and revise	Interactive wireframe prototype and critique log

FairChild Institute

Month 4

UI & Visual Design

Duration 4 weeks

Month Journey

Week	Theme	Core Topics	Guided Practical	Required Evidence
1	Visual hierarchy and layout	Composition, alignment, spacing, balance, contrast, proximity and grids	Apply a consistent spacing and grid system to wireframes	Visual layout exploration
2	Typography and colour	Type scales, line height, readability, colour roles, semantic colour and contrast	Create a compact typography and colour style guide	Foundational UI style guide
3	Interface patterns and accessibility	Buttons, forms, cards, tabs, alerts, modals; focus, error messages and touch targets	Build polished screens with accessible feedback states	Component-based high-fidelity screens
4	Mobile product design review	Visual consistency, responsive intent, design rationale and design critique	Complete a mobile savings, healthcare or education product flow	Mobile interface and design rationale

FairChild Institute

Month 5

Design Systems & Responsive Design

Duration 4 weeks

Month Journey

Week	Theme	Core Topics	Guided Practical	Required Evidence
1	Figma Auto Layout and constraints	Nested layouts; hug, fill and fixed sizing; responsive behaviour	Refactor a screen using Auto Layout	Responsive Figma layouts
2	Components and variants	Reusable components, properties, variants and nested components	Create a button, input, navigation and card library	Documented component library
3	Variables, tokens and themes	Colour, spacing, typography and semantic tokens; modes and theming	Define variables and build a small themeable UI kit	Token and variable specification
4	Complex dashboard application	Tables, charts, search, filters, notifications, empty/error states and data density	Design a logistics operations dashboard for desktop and narrower screens	Responsive dashboard and mini design system

FairChild Institute

Month 6

Prototyping & Interaction Design

Duration	4 weeks

Month Journey

Week	Theme	Core Topics	Guided Practical	Required Evidence
1	Interaction principles	Affordances, feedback, microinteractions, motion and system status	Annotate interaction behaviour for a selected user flow	Interaction specification
2	Advanced Figma prototyping	Overlays, Smart Animate, scrolling and interactive components	Prototype a multi-step task including overlays	Clickable high-fidelity prototype
3	Exceptional and failure states	Validation, permission denied, offline, loading and error recovery	Add realistic success and recovery paths	State-complete prototype
4	Prototype review and handoff	Stakeholder walkthroughs, design reviews, developer communication and revision	Run a demonstration and capture implementation questions	Reviewed prototype and handoff notes

FairChild Institute

Month 7

Design & AI

Duration	4 weeks

Month Journey

Week	Theme	Core Topics	Guided Practical	Required Evidence
1	AI in the design workflow	AI-supported ideation and research synthesis; limitations, hallucinations and bias	Compare AI-generated suggestions with observed user evidence	Evidence-vs-suggestion comparison
2	AI-assisted interface exploration	Prompting for layout alternatives, content options and component ideas	Generate alternatives and assess usability, consistency and accessibility	Annotated concept comparison
3	Responsible AI and design quality	Privacy, intellectual property, accessibility and human oversight	Audit AI-assisted text and interface suggestions against a checklist	Risk and quality audit
4	AI-assisted design sprint	Rapid ideation, prototyping and evaluation with transparent tool use	Revise one product feature using AI support and justify final decisions	Design experiment, prototype and decision log

FairChild Institute

Month 8

Usability Testing & Product Thinking

Duration 4 weeks

Month Journey

Week	Theme	Core Topics	Guided Practical	Required Evidence
1	Product thinking and test strategy	User value, business objectives, success criteria and prioritisation	Define testable product assumptions and task success criteria	Product hypothesis and test plan
2	Usability test preparation	Moderated/ unmoderated approaches, recruitment, consent, scripts and tasks	Write a practical test script for a prototype	Participant script and task checklist
3	Testing and evidence capture	Observe task completion, time on task, errors, satisfaction and qualitative feedback	Run a small supervised usability test and document observations	Findings and issue-priority matrix
4	Iteration and product trade-offs	Severity, feasibility, user impact and testing-informed redesign	Improve key screens and compare before/ after evidence	Usability report and revised prototype

FairChild Institute

Month 9

Design Communication & Presentation

Duration 4 weeks

Month Journey

Week	Theme	Core Topics	Guided Practical	Required Evidence
1	Design storytelling	Problem → Context → Research → Insight → opportunity → Solution → Impact	Outline a case study using an existing project	Case-study narrative outline
2	Presentation design in Figma	Slide hierarchy, grids, typography, composition and one-idea-per-slide	Build a 10–12-slide deck using reusable Figma layouts	Presentation draft
3	Communicating with stakeholders	Design rationale for clients, product managers, engineers and executives	Present research and design trade-offs to peers	Critique feedback and revision notes
4	Demo and presentation rehearsal	Prototype demonstration, timing, Q&A and defending decisions	Deliver a 5–10-minute practice presentation	Polished deck and rehearsal feedback

FairChild Institute

Month 10

Final Project

Duration 4 weeks

Month Journey

Week	Theme	Core Topics	Guided Practical	Required Evidence
1	Capstone discovery and definition	Select a real-world problem, define users, goals, constraints and research plan	Create a scoped capstone brief and initial evidence base	Capstone brief and research artifacts
2	Capstone UX and UI delivery	Research synthesis, flows, wireframes, high-fidelity screens and systems	Design a coherent end-to-end product experience	Complete design file and component set
3	Capstone validation and refinement	Interactive prototype, user testing, iteration and design documentation	Test critical tasks and improve the experience	Validated prototype and iteration record
4	Portfolio and professional showcase	Case-study writing, handoff, professional reviews, interviews and Q&A	Present final project and curate portfolio with process and outcomes	Final case study, portfolio and showcase deck

FairChild Institute

Month 11-12

Professional Practice

Duration 4 weeks

Course Practical Evidence

Month-end deliverable: Capstone case study, portfolio and live design defence.

Review protocol: Learner submits an organised working file, a brief decision log, a demonstration or walkthrough, and a revision responding to mentor feedback.

Progression Gate

The learner should be able to explain and demonstrate the month-end deliverable without step-by-step mentor intervention before moving to the next course.

FairChild Institute